Julie Exel

Senior Software Engineer | Full Stack, Cloud Architecture, APIs & AI/LLM Development

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 18+ years of experience building full-stack applications, APIs, and cloud infrastructure on AWS and Azure. Specializes in modernizing legacy systems into scalable, API-driven architectures using microservices, serverless computing, event-driven design, machine learning, and AI/LLM development. Technical leader and mentor with industry experience in finance, natural gas, insurance, and aviation. AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate.

SKILLS

Languages: C#, Python, Java, JavaScript, PHP, Swift, SwiftUI, SQL

Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular, Vue.js, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS

Backend & APIs: .NET, Node.js, Spring Boot, Laravel, RESTful APIs, GraphQL, gRPC, JSON, XML, OAuth 2.0, JWT, OpenAPI/Swagger, Postman

Cloud & Serverless: AWS, AWS Lambda, AWS API Gateway, Amazon SQS, Azure, Azure App Service, Azure Functions, Azure API Management, Kong, Kafka

Data & Databases: Microsoft SQL Server, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Realm, ETL, query optimization, real-time data streaming

DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, Argo, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, CI/CD pipelines, Fastly, PostHog

AI & Machine Learning: AI/LLM application development, OpenAI API, Claude API (Anthropic), PyTorch, neural networks, data pre-processing pipelines, predictive analytics

Architecture & Practices: Microservices, API-first design, event-driven architecture, domain-driven design (DDD), IAM, secrets management, observability (logging, monitoring, tracing), unit testing, Agile

Leadership: Technical leadership, mentorship, cross-functional collaboration, stakeholder engagement

EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer, Agility CMS

Toronto, ON (Remote) | Oct 2025 - Present

- Develop and maintain a headless CMS platform, shipping customer-requested features and fixes that improve reliability, performance, and user experience.
- Build full-stack features with React, Next.js, and C# across frontend and backend services.
- Design and support Azure cloud infrastructure, including App Services, storage, monitoring, and deployment pipelines.
- Integrate Fastly and PostHog to improve edge delivery, performance monitoring, and customer analytics.
- Partner with customer support and product teams to turn client feedback and support tickets into technical solutions.
- Reduce technical debt by resolving production issues and improving developer workflows.

IT Consultant / iOS Software Engineer, Pegasus

Edmonton, AB (Remote) | Feb 2025 - Oct 2025

- Designed and maintained secure, cost-optimized Azure cloud infrastructure and CI/CD pipelines.
- Developed cross-platform applications using Swift and Node.js with RESTful API integrations.
- Built automated API test suites in Postman to reduce regressions.
- Delivered responsive, production-ready features with product and design teams using Figma.
- Led end-to-end delivery from requirements gathering and architecture through deployment and monitoring.

Senior Software Engineer, Bellwood - Chick-fil-A

Atlanta, GA (Remote) | May 2022 - Feb 2025

- Architected and implemented AI-driven solutions to modernize legacy enterprise systems.
- Developed a proprietary backpropagation-based machine learning system for internal financial controls.
- Improved fraud detection and reporting by optimizing data workflows.
- Built custom data pre-processing pipelines for large-scale datasets.
- Achieved and maintained approximately 90% unit test coverage.
- Mentored developers on engineering best practices, improving delivery speed and code quality.

Senior Application Developer, NAL Insurance
London, ON (Hybrid) | Jun 2020 - Dec 2021

- Rewrote and modernized legacy VB.NET applications, improving performance and maintainability.
- Refactored complex Microsoft SQL Server stored procedures and queries to reduce execution time.
- Developed JavaScript frontend functionality to modernize the user experience.
- Partnered with business analysts to design scalable replacements for outdated systems.
- Documented system architecture and migration paths to support future cloud adoption.

Senior Application Developer & Team Lead, HRDownloads
London, ON | Jun 2019 - Dec 2019

- Led development of containerized Docker applications supporting real-time data streaming.
- Implemented caching and query optimization to improve performance of data-intensive systems.

Senior Software Developer & Team Lead, Doxim
London, ON | Jun 2018 - Jan 2019

- Led a team of developers designing and deploying personalization features for client-facing applications.
- Collaborated with product owners to define and deliver features.

Senior Application Developer, Union Gas
London, ON | Jan 2012 - Jun 2018

- Led modernization of backend and frontend systems.
- Enhanced internal data visualization dashboards to support operational decision-making.
- Provided 24/7 on-call support for business-critical applications.

Application Developer, GateSeven Media Group
London, ON | Apr 2009 - May 2011

- Built websites from design mockups using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, ColdFusion, AJAX, and JSON.
- Implemented online payment processing with Authorize.Net and Moneris.
- Maintained websites, CMS content, and end-user documentation; performed functional testing throughout the development lifecycle.

QA Analyst, Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce (CIBC)
Toronto, ON | Sep 2008 - Dec 2008

- Created test cases from business requirements and tested banking software in English and French for bilingual compliance.

Junior .NET Developer, illumiCell Corporation / Multiplied Media
Thornton, ON | May 2007 - May 2008

- Built and maintained dynamic websites and developed instant messaging bots for MSN Messenger and AIM using object-oriented programming and unit testing.

EDUCATION

Computer Programming, Georgian College of Applied Arts & Technology
Sep 2006 - Apr 2009

Coursework: Java, Oracle, DB2, Networking, PHP, Mainframe Technologies

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate, Amazon Web Services